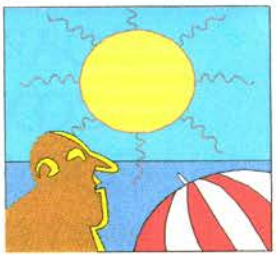
MOUNTAINEER

SUMMER 1997 Volume 4 Issue 4



SUMMER

CMA ELECTS NEW BOARD MEMBERS

On Saturday, July 19, 1997 CMA elected three new members to serve on the Board of Directors. Elected were Charles Balkan, Joan Bradfield and Lee Weinberger.

Charlie Balkan has called "A Peaceable Balkan" H-4, his home away from home since 1994. If you are out walking the loop or on any of the trails, you are sure to run into Charlie. When you see him, ask him about the bear that HE scared away.

Joan Bradfield, and her late husband, Jim, moved into their home, Three Oaks, N-3 & N-2, in 1986. Joan was the Chairman of the Social Committee this past year and was the driving force behind the "Telephone Tree." Maybe you have seen Joan on TV, she's been an extra on a number of shows, including Homicide.

(*continued on page 2)*

NEIGHBOR TO NEIGHBOR

This is our third article in this series. If you would like to write something, please send it to Mary Ann Siushansian

By Herb & Renee Jasper

We have owned H-2 and H-3 for 22 years. After a career that included an active role in the early development and application of computer technology, Renee retired from the Department of Education where she headed a management systems division. I worked on government-wide organization and management at the former Budget Bureau and in the US Senate. Later, I helped to break up AT&T. An elected Fellow of the National Academy of Public Administration I have testified at congressional hearings on management reform issues five times since 1995. Both of us now work as management consultants.

Our principal Coolfont pleasures are hiking, swimming and bird watching. We have traveled to Texas to see the surviving Whooping Cranes and are off to Australia, New Zealand and Fiji this Fall. We have also watched birds in Baja, Hawaii, Arizona, Costa Rica, Ecuador, Guatemala, Israel, Europe, and India. We have two children and one grandchild.

While Renee spends a lot of time reading and relaxing, I have been active in CMA. I was a member of the nominating committee five times and chair twice; member of the five committees whose work led to the 1986 agreement with CDC that settled two lawsuits and to the 1995 expansion agreement; chair, 1986, and member, 1995, bylaws revision committees; mediator of the dispute between CDC and CMA that led to agreement on CDC's contribution to rebuilding the North Loop; and chair of the 1993-94 Long Range Budget Planning Committee.

BOARD MEMBER CORNER

This month's guest writer is Janice Dring.

Our family first found Coolfont while looking for camping places about 1977. Our son, David, liked camping near the lake to swim, use the paddle boats or hike. Our daughter, Cheryl, was away at college and not always around for weekend trips or summer vacations. We kept coming back to the same camp site and then decided to build a house which was completed in 1980. Our house was named "Narnia" after the land of adventure in the Chronicles by C.S. Lewis. We have enjoyed our home in the trees which is such a short commute from Rockville.

As I write this, Lon and I are just returning from vacation in Chautauqua in western New York near Jamestown. In many ways this area of West Virginia has similar characteristics. Besides being surrounded by nature and our little lake, we have many opportunities for music, art and learning from the programs through Coolfont Foundation. In the summer, we enjoy our swimming pool, tennis and nearby golf. In the winter, we like sitting by the wood stove to read and relax or enjoy cross country skiing.

We've enjoyed our mountainside neighbors and found this to be a great community for all seasons.

Janice Dring

(CMA elections continued from page 1)

Lee Weinberger was re-elected to a second term on the Board. As you all know, Lee has been doing a fantastic job overseeing the installation of our new water system upgrade. He's out there every day checking to make sure that things are being done correctly. Lee and Greta built their home in 1992 and are one of the few members that live here year round.

All three new members, as well as the former members, Jackson Bain, Tim Black, Janice Dring, and Roland Siushansian, are all looking forward to a year that will be filled with good times, good friends, and seeing each other often. We will be holding the Board meetings every month at various homes in Coolfont, as we did last year (see the calendar on page 7). They will be followed by pot luck dinners or some kind of social event. The dinners were a great success....but we would like to see some new faces that didn't make it last year. There was always too much food, laughter, conversation and lots of fun. So, why not plan to come and join the fun. You're missing some great evenings.

As you all know, CMA is made up of volunteers and we need more. All it takes is a little bit of your time and more of your "brainpower." Please give any of the Board Members a call, or you can contact Mary Ann Siushansian at the Mountaineer Newsletter. We are also looking for more people to write articles for the newsletter; specifically the Neighbor to Neighbor column and the Old and New columns. You can send any articles to Mary Ann.

We hope everyone has had a great summer and we hope to see you at the Board meetings and pot luck dinners.

COMMITTEE UPDATES

NOMINATION COMMITTEE

Richard Lehman

The election of new members to the CMA Board at the Annual Meeting was conducted under terms of new procedures that included : a) the issuance of a separate ballot package to every owner, b) the use of a double envelope system and c) the use of original, not copied or faxed, ballot and proxy forms. There were 45 ballots from CMA members present, 33 mail-in ballots and 6 ballots were issued to proxy holders. Thus there were 84 ballots out of a possible 133 which equaled 63% participation.

There is a continuing problem of finding candidates who are willing to run. We spent more than two months searching for candidates and one or the other of us contacted every person whose name was given for consideration. The three candidates that we found to run were elected by acclamation when it became clear that no candidates were nominated from the floor and there were no votes cast for write-in candidates.



A VIEW FROM THE PAST PRESIDENT

Jackson Bain has served two terms as CMA President and as we bid a fond adieu to him, here are his last official words as our President:

After two years as President of CMA, it was my great pleasure to nominate and then hand over the gavel (if we actually had one) to Lee Weinberger. Looking back on the past two years, I'm struck by how much we've all accomplished for the mountainside...and each other.

I believe the best achievement is a greater effort to work together to solve problems. When Sandy and I first bought our home at Coolfont, the community was undergoing a difficult and sometimes acrimonious debate over common land issues, and the effort to resolve that debate was our introduction to CMA, its policies and its board. It was resolved, and it proved to me that greater light and less heat was needed to keep our community moving forward. Of course, neighbors still disagree; that's part of being a "village". But, as past leaders of CMA have always known, progress doesn't happen when there is anger: only anger happens.

The proof-of-the-pudding is the near completion of the new water system, and the plans for resurfacing the South Mountainside Road. More proof: A sure-to-be-terrific 25th Anniversary weekend, some easy and unanimous updating changes to the Bylaws, and a new CMA Board eager and ready to seek out and solve emerging challenges. All accomplished with neighbors working for the community as a whole.

This place is terrific. We take our inspiration and sense of peace from the timeless mountain and the forest that greens us all. The environment is us, in many ways, and we are the environment. Do you want to see the real face of Coolfont? Come here, spend 24 hours breathing the air, then look in the mirror.

Thank you all for your support and for your friendship; please continue to volunteer to make this magical hillside even better.

Jackson



AND ONE FROM THE PRESENT

Lee Weinberger is our new CMA President, and here are a few official words from him:

I wish to thank the members for re-electing me to the Board of Directors and the Board for electing me as the President. Let me acknowledge the former Boards for the efforts that they have achieved.

The coming year we are planning to review the assessment fee and the water water. The priority for spending is going to be: roads, water supply, sewage disposal, pool, tennis courts, barn, snow removal, security, maintenance equipment and the common ground.

We are also going to review the regulations and guidelines for building, and the regulations regarding the use of property. The tree policy is also going to be reviewed. The By-laws are going to be looked at and possibly updated. We will also look at the enforcement of the covenants and restrictions, By-laws and regulations. The T-section will also be looked at.

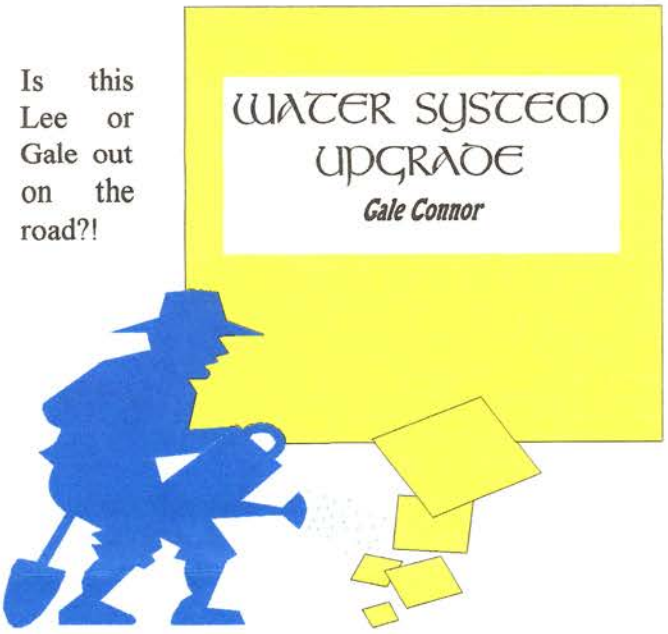
At CMA we have a recreational community with permanent parks, wilderness, open spaces and other common facilities for the benefit of the community. In order to provide the preservation of the values and amenities in this community and for the maintenance of the common facilities, we need more volunteers from among our members.

During the last year I have noticed the enthusiasm with which a number of our members have volunteered to do work for the benefit of CMA; especially the Social, Communications, Utilities, DACC, Finance, Recreation and Nomination Committees. I urge all our older and newer members, full-time and second home residents to volunteer their services.

Go to the Board meetings, discuss ideas or problems, or give a Board member a call.

Lee

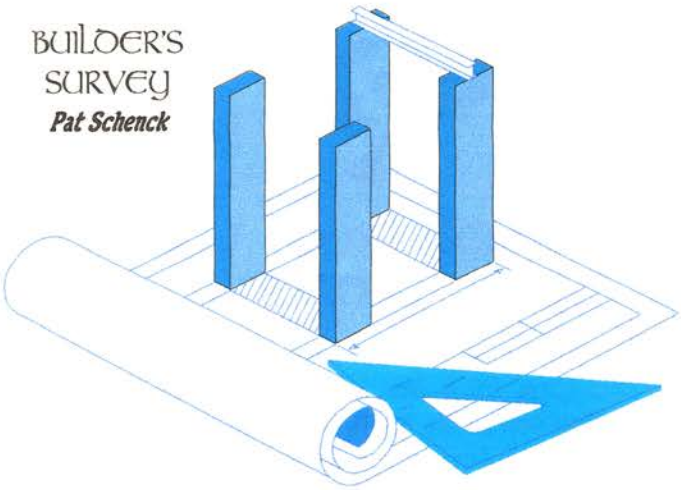
Is this Lee or Gale out on the road?!



The north and the south reservoirs are united! The new south reservoir has been connected by approximately 5,000 feet of 6" and 4" pipe to the existing north reservoir. That's progress!

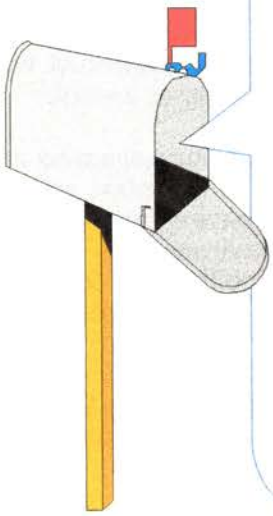
SYSTEM UPGRADE FACTS

- The south reservoir will have a storage capacity of 40,000 gallons.
- The combined capacity of our two wells is 86,000 gallons per day. That's a lot of showers!!!
- Water loss due to leaks exceeds **50%** of the water pumped from our wells.
- The upgrade project has cost approximately $150,000 so far. The total cost is estimated to be $225,000 (well within our budget).
- CMA has acted as it's own General Contractor. This means that we have had the "pleasure" (?) of dealing with 14 different contractor/vendors. Not to mention the amount of money that we have been able to save!



A contractor survey that was sent to five owners of recent new construction, revealed the following recommendations:

- Two owners submitted excellent recommendations for the builder, Don Hoover, of Berkeley Builders.
- One owner recommended TPI, Don McDanel, in Berkeley Springs for inspections.
- One owner recommended John Lewis for inspections.
- One owner recommended Sally Muros, of Silver Spring as an architect.



MAILBAG

If you would like to have a copy of the corrected and amended minutes from the Board meetings contact:

Mary Ann Siushansian
17302 Parson Grove Ter.
Olney MD 20832
301-774-2738 or
304-258-6384

Houses for Sale

Q-9 Montebello.... ...$194,800
E-1 Tamarack.....$119,500
K-8 Fox's Den.....$139,500
L-1 Canaan.....$109,500

Lots for Sale

E-3.....$33,000
H-1.....$47,500
K-1.....$42,500
K-2.....$38,000
K-1 & K-2.....$78,000
K-14.....$45,000
Q-7.....$47,000
S-6.....$68,950

Homeowners who rent privately and have expressed interest in joining together for advertising and referrals should call Eva Lehman.

New Officers Elected

At the August 16 Board meeting held at the Siushansian's the following people have taken on the responsibilities of the officers for the Board of Directors:

- President: Lee Weinberger
- Vice President: Jackson Bain
- Treasurer: Roland Siushansian
- Secretary: Janice Dring

We need to have more volunteers help with all of the committees. Please try and give a helping hand. You'll not only learn something new but also make more friends on the mountainside.

See the enclosed sheet for the names of the new committee chairs. Make sure that you replace this sheet in your directory with the old one.

Committee Updates

Communications

Rosemary Bigelow

The Weinberger's home was the perfect setting for the Newcomers' Brunch, held May 4. The food was excellent and was provided by members of the sponsoring Social and Communications Committees. The party was a big success with about 40 people attending; eleven of which were newcomers. Carroll Yingling welcomed everyone on behalf of the Board. There was lots of socializing and eating. Thank you Lee and Greta for being the perfect hosts.

If you are new to the CMA Community and haven't received a newcomers' information packet, please contact Kitty Connor, 304-258-3975.

Rosemary Bigelow will continue to be the chairperson of the Communications/Social Committee.

Recreation

Charlie Balkan

The Recreation Committee has determined that they need to meet on a more regular basis than they did last year.

Most of the time and energy was focused on the pool. We seem to have finally created a reasonable system for it's us. Unfortunately, if the members and others don't cooperate, it is all for nil.

We have asked Sam Ashelman and the Coolfont Development Corporation to put up signs along the walking trails stating that motor vehicles, including cars, dirt and regular bikes are not allowed on the trails, as they tear them up.

Social Committee

Joan Bradfield

A **big** thank you to those who helped with the telephone tree—-Vince Amoroso & Tam Milton, Charlie Balkan, Marie Barrett, Pat Betts, Myra Birnkrant, Connie Dupre, Leila Keese, Eva Lehman, Mary Ann Siushansian, Ingrid Sophar, Betty Szadokirski, Pat Waters and Greta Weinberger. Another round of thanks goes to all those generous and hospitable folks who hosted our pot luck dinners: Jackson & Sandy Bain, Roland & Mary Ann Siushansian, Carroll & Phyllis Yingling and Joan Bradfield.

How My House Got Its Name

Did you ever wonder how some of the houses on the mountainside got their name? Here's how The Hearth got its

When Roland and I were building our house on Q-3 we had no idea what to call it. We thought of naming it after my music company or something to do with Roland's company, or our daughter Dena. We really had no idea until I read a book called A Family Place. There was a passage that captured exactly what we wanted our home to be.

HEARTH IS:
HEAT, HEART AND EARTH
COMBINED

A PLACE
AN EARTH OF THE HEART THAT
PROVIDES HEAT AGAINST THE
COLD OF THE WORLD
A PLACE OF GATHERING
A CENTER WHERE FRIENDS AND
FAMILY TALK, FEAST, LAUGH
AND WORK TOGETHER
CELEBRATE EACH DAY
REJOICE TOGETHER IN GOOD
FORTUNE, NEW JOBS, SUCCESSES
AND EVEN FAILURES
GIVE ADVICE AND LOVE TO ALL
WHO COME TO
OUR DOOR

Roland and Mary Ann Siushansian

the new

A CLOSER LOOK AT A NEW-COMER

Let's take a look at one of our newer members on the mountainside.

by Dilys M. Parry & Richard F. Kaufman

A few short years ago, in 1993, Dilys was looking forward to her most major birthday yet - numero 50. Richard, her faithful companion, and husband, offered a choice of gifts to celebrate the event: a trip to San Juan, Puerto Rico, or a stay in the vacation spa of her choice.

Dilys, as it happened, had read a description of Atlantic area spas in the latest issue of Vogue. "I've heard good things about Coolfont, in West Virginia, she said." Richard promptly called (to take advantage of a winter special) and made reservations. But a winter storm intervened and the trip was postponed. Bad weather intervened once again in the spring and it was not until Labor Day that the February promise was fulfilled.

The weekend was a delight. Coolfont has the kind of natural beauty, wonderful buffets and other amenities that make us happy. It is also close to home (Bethesda, MD), and, or crucial importance, within Dilys' weekend automobile trip comfort time zone: two hours or less!

One thought led to another and we were soon inquiring about vacation property at Coolfont. Sam Ashelman, the owner, gave us a grand tour of the mountainside. We were not prepared to buy a house and did not, at first, see a lot that was right for us.

Sam stayed in touch. In the late fall he called us at Bethesda. There was a property, he said, that someone else owned but that might be available if we were interested. We saw it and we were interested. By that time, we were coming to know some of the mountainside owners and other Coolfont and Berkeley Springs people, and we like most of them. Although the lot Sam showed us went to the edge of our price range, it was just right.

Much to our own surprise, and after the usual unmentionable adventures, we actually built a house on the mountainside. We and our family now enjoy great stays at Lady Bug House. How it got that name is another story!

the old

A CLOSER LOOK AT AN "OLD-TIMER"

Now, here's another look at members who have been here a while.

by Gerry and Ingrid Sophar

Trolls are ugly and mischievous Norwegian little people. A few of them have migrated to America and live with us at Trollbakken. Trollbakken means where the trolls dwell.

Thirty-seven years ago, during the summer of 1960 we vacationed for a week at a cabin on a hill at a place called Lotus Lake Farm. The farm was a few miles west of Berkeley Springs. Today, Lotus Lake Farm is called Coolfont.

It may be of some interest how we found this place. We were happy campers then, really roughing it. We owned a large pyramidal tent and spent many nights in that tent with our two young daughters. We had reserved camping space on a farm about six miles outside of Berkeley Springs. After one night we knew that we didn't like the facility. While driving to the campsite we had seen a sign at the Western end of Cold Run Valley Road advertising available cabins at Lotus Lake Farm. So, we packed up our things and returned the few miles to Lotus Lake Farm an spent the rest of our vacation there. There was no Lake Siri there then, it was built later. Swimming was in the pond in front of the Manor House. Horseback riding was available and our older daughter went. While there, we were told by the caretaker/manager that the property was for sale. The price was right and we dawdled with the idea of purchasing it, but decided against it.

We forgot about Lotus Lake Farm for twelve or thirteen years until friends told us about a development outside of Berkeley Springs called Coolfont. From their description it seemed likely that it was the same place we had vacationed at more than a decade earlier. In 1973 we visited Coolfont and in 1974 we purchased lot J-1 and built Trollbakken in 1978. Our contractor and builder was Carson Johnson. We want to thank him publicly for delivering what he promised. Not a crack nor a flaw has appeared in our home in almost twenty years, except for a small part of a deck where wood ants have had some fun.

August 1997

We live at Leisure World in Silver Spring, only two hours from Trollbakken. From 1978 on we have spent three weekends out of every month at our WV retreat. During most of the year, we play golf at Cacapon State Park on Saturday and Sunday mornings. In our opinion, this marvelous course is the most valuable amenity that the area and Coolfont have to offer. It is hard to understand that Coolfont hasn't attracted more golfers because of this facility. From time to time, aft retirement in 1986, we gave serious thought to selling and doing something else for a change. The golf course always pulled us back!

BOARD MEETING DATES

Please put the following dates on your calendars.

SEPTEMBER 13 10:00
WHERE: JOAN BRADFIELD'S
SOCIAL: WEINBERGER'S
OCTOBER 4 10:00
WHERE SIUSHANSIAN'S
SOCIAL BRADFIELD'S
NOVEMBER 15 10:00
WHERE WEINBERGER'S
SOCIAL BIGELOW'S
DECEMBER 6 10:00
WHERE BALKAN'S
SOCIAL SIUSHANSIAN'S
JANUARY 10 10:00
WHERE BAIN'S
SOCIAL TBA
FEBRUARY 7 10:00
WHERE ORING'S
SOCIAL TBA
MARCH 14 10:00
WHERE BROXSON'S
SOCIAL TBA
APRIL 18 10:00
WHERE KAUFMAN'S
SOCIAL TBA
MAY 9 10:00
WHERE TBA
SOCIAL TBA
JUNE 13 10:00
WHERE BALKAN'S
SOCIAL TBA
JULY 18 9:00
WHERE TREETOP
ANNUAL MEETING: JULY 18 1:00
TREETOP



JULY BOARD MINUTES SUMMARY

The meeting was held on July 19 at 9:15 at Treetop Lodge at Coolfont. The Board discussed the resignation of the DACC, which objected to earlier Board decisions to resolve inspection impasses at two homes, and other cases where the CMA/DACC regulations and guidelines were not strictly followed. Jackson Bain stated the Board needed to take action in some instances on a case by case basis to resolve disputes, and that CMA cannot become a liable party between the owner and the builder/developer. Herb Jasper urged a uniform policy toward the Guidelines, and revision of the Guidelines to allow this if necessary. The Board agreed to look at the Guidelines and make recommendations, and expressed thanks to the former members of the DACC for their hard work and dedication. The new Board will appoint a new DACC.

In other business, Finance Committee Chair, Bob Dowling, praised Lee Weinberger and Gale Connor for saving over $100,000 on the new water system project. He stated that after the system is up and operating, we can determine its operation costs and make a decision on reducing water rates and assessments.

(continued on page 8)

(minutes continued)

Richard Kaufmann, author of the upgrade subcommittee report, wants a further study of replacing the "R" reservoir. He stated that thirteen homes currently are served by that storage facility, and questioned how they would be served if the reservoir failed. He will put his conclusions in the form of a written recommendation to the new Board.

The Board approved the agenda for the Annual Meeting later in the afternoon.

What's Happening in Berkeley Springs

The Morgan Arts Council is sponsoring several events this summer and fall: A series of gallerie showings of local artists' work will be held every weekend at the Ice House, from mid-August to the first week in December. CMA member Rosemary Bigelow is one of the featured artists. The Ice House is located at the corner of Independence and Mercer Streets.

There are a number of art workshops for children, contact Jill Rone, 258-3302 for details. For details of all events contact Travel Berkeley Springs 1-800-447-8797.

It's not too early to mark your calendars for the annual Apple Butter Festival, October 11-12 in downtown Berkeley Springs. The Glens Country Estate offers 6 course candlelight dinners.. Reservations required, 258-4536.

Activities Wanted?

Would you enjoy getting together on weekends with other CMA members who share similar interests as you? If so, contact Rosemary Bigelow. Some ideas would be: hiking, bird watching, bridge, mahjong, needle work, gourmet dinners, movies, books and whatever else captures your fancy.

25th Anniversary Update

Eva Lehman

- **COME: TO CELEBRATE THE 25TH ANNIVERSARY OF THE CMA,** on Saturday, September 27th. Follow the balloons to the barn between 10 and 11 A.M.- a warm welcome awaits you. Receive your name tag, your dinner tickets and register for organized sports events planned for both Saturday and Sunday. Meet your hosts, if you are staying overnight, and obtain directions to shelters in case of rain, or to a friendly mountainside home, where you and your children can relax or take an afternoon nap.

- **BRING:** Food for the pot luck lunch, your most comfortable shoes for Saturday afternoon hikes with Elmer and Charlie, your gear for golf or tennis, and your most pleasant memories of CMA events to share at the Saturday dinner dedicated to 25 years of "CMA Recollections."

- **REMEMBER:** To send in your response form with your check for your Saturday night dinner by August 31. Also if you have photos or items of historical interest send them to Elmer Broxson.

- **ENJOY:** A wine and cheese social hour at the barn preceding our "Memorial Dinner" - a buffet including entrees of scalloped oysters, baked chicken and ham, Swedish meatballs and other scrumptious fare. Then be prepared for a good scare from Mystery-on-the-Menu. And, best of all, throughout these two days of joyous celebration the special excitement of meeting and interacting with old friends and new neighbors on the Coolfont Mountainside.